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Project Management

Mercy Valley Hospital — SWIFT Risk Assessment

Schedule Risks

1. What if data migration takes longer than expected?

The project could fall behind schedule and miss its deadline. Starting data migration early could help prevent this.

2. What if vendor resources become unavailable?

The project could experience delays if the vendor doesn't have enough workers. Having backup consultants could help.

3. What if testing discovers critical defects late in the project?

This could delay the launch and affect patient care. Testing throughout the project could help catch these issues earlier.

Cost Risks

4. What if additional software licenses are required?

The hospital could go over its $8 million budget. Planning for licensing costs early could prevent this.

5. What if consultants exceed their contracted hours?

This could increase project costs. The hospital should track consultant hours and limit unnecessary overtime.

6. What if rework is needed after user acceptance testing?

This could increase costs and delay the project. Testing earlier could help reduce the amount of rework needed.

Technical Risks

7. What if migrated data is inaccurate?

Incorrect patient records could lead to medical mistakes. The hospital should verify the data before launching the system.

8. What if interfaces with laboratory systems fail?

Doctors might not receive test results on time, which could delay treatment. Testing these connections early could prevent this.

9. What if the cloud environment experiences outages?

Hospital staff could lose access to patient records. Having backup systems could help reduce disruptions.

Resource Risks

10. What if physicians cannot participate in testing?

Important problems could go unnoticed. The hospital should schedule testing around physicians' availability.

11. What if key team members leave the project?

The project could slow down because of lost experience. Cross-training employees could help prevent this.

12. What if internal IT staff are diverted to emergency operational issues?

The project could fall behind because fewer employees are available. Having backup IT staff could help.

Compliance Risks

13. What if HIPAA security requirements are overlooked?

Patient information could be exposed, and the hospital could face penalties. Regular security reviews could prevent this.

14. What if a cybersecurity vulnerability is identified before go-live?

Attackers could potentially exploit the vulnerability. The hospital should fix serious security issues before launching.

Stakeholder Risks

15. What if nursing staff resist the new system?

Nurses might struggle to adjust, which could affect patient care. Providing training could make the transition easier.

16. What if executive support decreases because of project delays?

The project could lose important resources and funding. Keeping leadership updated could help maintain their support.

ID	Risk description	Category	Prob.	Impact	Score	Response strategy / action	Owner
R1	Patient records become inaccurate during migration	Technical	High (3)	Very High (4)	12	Mitigate — run trial migrations and verify records	Data Migration Lead
R2	Data migration takes longer than planned	Schedule	High (3)	Very High (4)	12	Mitigate — begin migrations early and track deadlines	Project Manager
R3	Laboratory systems fail to connect with the EHR	Technical	High (3)	Very High (4)	12	Mitigate — test interfaces before the system goes live	Technical Lead
R4	Cloud outage prevents access to patient records	Technical	Medium (2)	Very High (4)	8	Mitigate — establish backups and recovery procedures	IT Manager
R5	Vendor does not have enough available workers	Schedule	Medium (2)	High (3)	6	Transfer — use vendor SLAs; arrange backup staffing	Project Manager
R6	Additional licenses increase project costs	Cost	Medium (2)	High (3)	6	Mitigate — review licenses early and monitor costs	Finance Manager
R7	Physicians are unavailable to test the system	Resource	High (3)	High (3)	9	Mitigate — schedule testing early around physicians	Clinical Lead
R8	HIPAA requirements are overlooked	Compliance	Medium (2)	Very High (4)	8	Mitigate — conduct security and compliance reviews	Compliance Officer
R9	A security vulnerability is found before launch	Security	Medium (2)	Very High (4)	8	Mitigate — scan, test and fix serious vulnerabilities	Security Manager
R10	Nursing staff have trouble adjusting to the EHR	Stakeholder	High (3)	High (3)	9	Mitigate — provide training and involve nurses in testing	Change Manager